Ecozones

Biomes are about identifying the similar forms that life takes in response to particular regional conditions such as climate, soil, and topography. However, there are other methods of dividing the world in ecological terms. In 1973, Hungarian biologist Miklos Udvardy came up with the concept of biogeographic realms; this system was then further developed in a scheme by the World Wildlife Fund. The BBC later replaced the term “biogeographic realm” with “ecozone.” Biogeographic realms divide the whole planet according to the evolutionary history of plants and animals. The ways in which continents have split apart and drifted means that species have evolved variously in different parts of the world. Ecozones are therefore based on identifying this diversification. Australasia, for example, is a single ecozone, because marsupials evolved there in isolation from other mammals in the rest of the world.